

## Marketing and Market Research

# International Business Projects

WIRTSCHAFTS UNIVERSITÄT WIEN VIENNA UNIVERSITY OF ECONOMICS AND BUSINESS

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SYLLABUS WT 2026/27

# Module Convenor – Dr Arne Floh



## Personal Information

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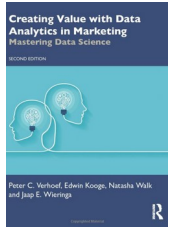
## Contact Information

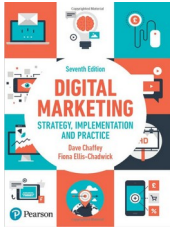
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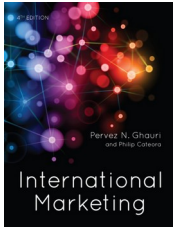
# Module Convenor – Dr Arne Floh

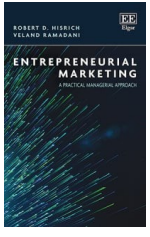


- Work Experience
  - International & Industry Background
  - Teaching Experience > 25 Years
- Teaching
  - International Marketing
  - International Business Projects
  - Marketing Research and Marketing Analytics
  - Global Branding
  - Supervision (BSc, MSc, PhD)
- Research
  - Dynamic Capabilties and Firm Performance
  - GenAI and Marketing
  - SMEs and Internationalization
- Private
  - Football
  - Electronic Gadgets
  - Austrian Wine






















# Course synopsis

- Capstone-style course for students specializing in International Business
- Core task: develop a comprehensive international marketing plan
- Marketing and marketing research at the core: investigate markets systematically and evaluate opportunities and risks
- Emphasis on critical thinking, project management and teamwork in a multicultural context
- Outcome: a structured international marketing plan with evidence-based strategic recommendations

# Learning objectives

## Research & analysis

- Conduct and interpret marketing research for evidence-based decisions
- Analyze competition, customer needs and cultural influences

## Strategy & planning

- Design and present a structured international marketing plan based on systematic analysis and research
- Apply marketing concepts internationally and evaluate opportunities and risks across markets
- Develop creativity and problem-solving to propose innovative, feasible strategies

## Teamwork & communication

- Strengthen teamwork, project management and intercultural collaboration
- Communicate complex ideas clearly and persuasively, in writing and orally

# Teaching and learning: flipped classroom

## Before class



- Independent research on key concepts and methods
- Preparation for the next session’s task
- Self-directed learning

## In class



- Discussion and application
- Coaching sessions and progress reports
- Peer feedback
- Theory directly connected to the project task

# The Julius Meinl case

Marketing plan for entering Latin America

# Our partner: Julius Meinl

**1862** family-owned Viennese coffee roaster, now in its fifth generation

**70+** countries: mostly through local distribution partners

**2** segments per market: hospitality and grocery retail

**Positioning:** Viennese coffee house culture rather than the bean itself, meaning service, hospitality and the idea of taking time for a cup of coffee



# How Julius Meinl sells: two segments, two partners

## Hospitality (HoReCa)

- Cafés, restaurants and hotels
- The primary segment: hotels matter most, with breakfast and bar business
- A dedicated partner, because hotels and grocery chains are different businesses

## Grocery retail

- Coffee for the home, through grocery chains and delicatessen
- Premium assortment
- A dedicated partner: with no own sales organisation in export markets, the partner is the sales force

# Who Julius Meinl sells to

| | |
|---|---|
| **Hospitality** | Hotels with breakfast and bar service, especially with international guests; premium restaurants and cafés; venues where coffee is part of a quality experience |
| **Retail** | Grocery and delicatessen with a premium assortment; shoppers who can pay a premium price; places where brands such as illy are already on the shelf |
| **Less relevant** | Venues and retailers competing on price, and areas without purchasing power |

# The question: growth in Latin America

Julius Meinl sees Latin America (South America and Mexico) as a potential future growth region, where it is currently not present or only marginally.



1. Which Latin American markets are attractive?
2. How could market entry look?
3. How should the brand be marketed?

**Central question:** Many Latin American countries grow and roast their own coffee and have a strong coffee culture. Why would cafés, hotels, retailers and consumers choose a coffee brand from Vienna, and who exactly would do so?

# Six markets, one set of criteria

## Markets compared by all groups




Simplified outlines, not to scale

## Common criteria by PESTEL dimension

- Political: stability, EU trade agreement
- Economic: purchasing power, consumption, tariff
- Social: coffee culture, tourism
- Technological: digital reach, logistics
- Environmental: demand for certified coffee
- Legal: regulation, product and labelling rules

# Assessment strategy

Three group presentations, self-reflection and peer review

# Overview of the presentations

| Presentation | Length | Weight | Focus |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 Content presentation | 15 min | 20 % | Market selection tools: theory, real-world applications, pitfalls |
| 2 Midterm presentation | 20 min | 30 % | Country scoring and industry analysis |
| 3 Final presentation | 25 min | 30 % | Marketing implementation plan |

# Presentation 1: market selection tools

**1 Content**
15 min · 20 %

**2 Midterm**
20 min · 30 %

**3 Final**
25 min · 30 %

- Review the tools companies use to screen, compare and select international markets
- Cover the theory, real-world applications and typical pitfalls (e.g., data availability, subjective weighting, outdated indicators)
- Recommend the tool best suited to compare the six Latin American markets for Julius Meinl
- Format: max. 15 minutes and 15 slides, information-rich with clear visualizations
- Document all sources in a separate Excel sheet

# Presentation 2: midterm

**1 Content**
15 min · 20 %

**2 Midterm**
20 min · 30 %

**3 Final**
25 min · 30 %

## Part A: Scoring method

- One common model: PESTEL criteria and fixed weights for all groups
- Collect and document the data of your allocated country
- Rank of your country among the six, scores by dimension
- Test robustness with the alternative weight sets provided
- Submit one Excel file and one presentation file (20 slides plus appendix); end with a justified recommendation

## Part B: Industry analysis

- Statistics from the allocated country
- Hotels and restaurants
- Cafes
- Private end customers
- Value chain, rules of the game
- Trends and online scan of prices

# Presentation 3: marketing implementation plan

**1 Content**
15 min · 20 %

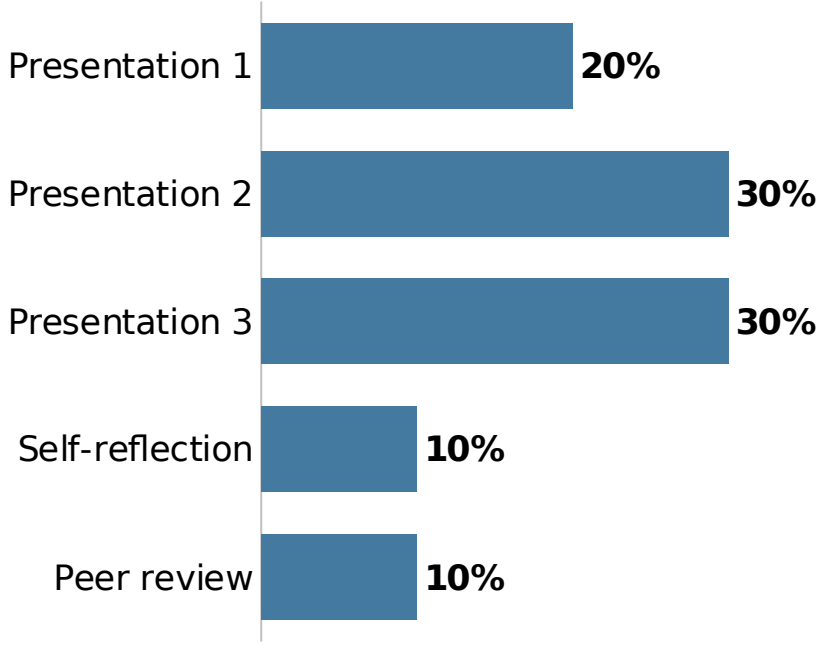
**2 Midterm**
20 min · 30 %

**3 Final**
25 min · 30 %

- Market entry and marketing plan for the assigned market: how the brand is marketed and how Julius Meinl enters the market
  - Target segment and first customers
  - Positioning, incl. the answer to the central question
  - Price positioning vs. competition
  - Distribution via a local partner, incl. a profile of a suitable partner
  - Communication and in-market activation (incl. creative implementation)
  - Rough timeline, first-year KPIs and key risks
- Format: max. 25 minutes

# Grading

## Grade components




## Grading scale

- 1 (90–100 %)
- 2 (80–89 %)
- 3 (70–79 %)
- 4 (51–69 %)
- 5 (0–50 %)

# Teaching schedule

## S1 · 5 Oct

**Course content and logistics**

→ Prepare content presentation

## S2 · 12 Oct

**Content presentation**

→ **PESTEL criteria search**

## S3 · 19 Oct

**Zoom coaching, 20 min per group**

→ **Collect data**

## S4 · 9 Nov

**Zoom coaching, 20 min per group**

→ **Prepare midterm presentation**

## S5 · 16 Nov

**Midterm presentation**

→ **Marketing plan**

## S6 · 23 Nov

**Coaching session, progress report**

→ Refinement and revision

## S7 · 30 Nov

**Coaching session, progress report**

→ Prepare final presentation

## S8 · 7 Dec

**Final presentation**

→ Self-reflection, peer review

# Data sources and framework conditions

## Framework conditions

- The project is based on publicly available data
- Julius Meinl provides no internal figures (revenues, margins, prices, partner names); none are needed
- When contacting companies or individuals, act as students on a university project, not on behalf of Julius Meinl

## Possible sources

- USDA coffee country reports
- Coffee import trade statistics
- National tourism statistics
- Public Julius Meinl material (corporate story, sustainability report, website)

# AI, self-reflection and peer review

## Use of AI

- Use of (Generative) AI tools is explicitly encouraged
- Tell a rich story in your presentations
- Be honest: list all tools you used
- Graded on quality, innovativeness and variety of sources

## Self-reflection and peer review

- Self-reflection: one page on what you learned, what you liked and what can be improved
- Peer review: rate the engagement and performance of your group mates (not yourself); kept confidential
- Submit via Canvas until one week after the last session

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